

POWER TAGS, WEAKNESS TAGS, & THE UPGRADE TRACK

A character begins the game with 3 power tags and 1 weakness tag in each theme. Additional power and weakness tags can be added as the theme improves. When a theme is replaced, the new theme starts out as a **nascent theme**, with just 1 power tag and 1 weakness tag.

Power tags are the heart of a theme and the main game element that players use in their actions. They are designed to directly help the PC's actions (although sometimes the MC may rule a power tag can be used as a weakness tag). Normally, only the player who controls the PC may invoke their power tags.

The first power tag of every theme (also known as the title tag) defines the entire nature and context of the theme.

Subsequent power tags describe specific aspects of features of the theme and are often related to the first power tag.

Weakness tags help a theme grow. They are designed to directly impede the PC's actions (although sometimes the MC may rule a weakness tag can be used as a power tag). Weakness tags can be invoked voluntarily by the player who controls the PC or involuntarily by the MC or a player whose PC is currently an opponent of the PC who owns the tag.

Every time a weakness tag is invoked to weaken the PC's action, the player marks one box on that theme's **upgrade track**. There are also rules throughout the game that can lead a player to mark an upgrade box on one of their themes (see **Upgrades**, page 133).

Once you mark all three upgrade boxes on a theme, the upgrade track is reset to zero and that theme gains an upgrade, allowing you to choose a new power tag, a new weakness tag, a theme Special, and more (see **Upgrades**, page 133). This represents your character focusing or giving more attention to that aspect of their life, overcoming its inherent obstacles, and enhancing it.

THEME SPECIALS

Theme Specials are special rules that enhance a PC's abilities. A PC normally starts without any theme Specials and must unlock them by upgrading the theme. You can find the list of theme Specials for each theme type under **Themebooks**, starting at page 196.

THE CREW

THE CREW THEME

The crew as a whole has its own theme card, which is shared between all the PCs. It describes the nature of the crew and their shared resources and goals.

Similarly to the PC's theme cards, the crew theme card has a motivation, 3 power tags, and one weakness tag, and may evolve to gain more tags and theme Specials.

The crew theme is a shared resource. It is used in the same way as the character themes, with the following differences:

- Any player may invoke any and all of the crew theme power tags or weakness tags. However, a crew power tag that is invoked is burned. It can be recovered in the same way a PC's power tag is recovered, or during the **Credit Roll** (page 125). A crew power tag cannot be **burned for Power** (page 122).
- The MC may invoke the crew theme weakness tag as part of any PC's action. The players mark an upgrade box on the crew theme for each such invocation, and the players all choose together the **Crew Theme Upgrades** (page 134).
- The crew motivation applies to all crew members and the Decay box is marked whenever any PC acts against the motivation. If a crew theme is replaced, the crew breaks up, and must first find a new reason to work together before they can create a new nascent crew theme.

CREW RELATIONSHIPS

Your character card includes tags that reflect your relationships with other crew members. For each of the other PCs in your crew, you have one tag representing your relationship with that PC, listed next to their name on your character card.

- You will always have only one relationship tag with each other PC (they will have their own relationship tag with you).
- The crew relationship tags are not part of a theme.
- You can invoke these tags just like any other tag. However, like the tags from the crew theme, these tags are burned when they are invoked, and they cannot be **burned for Power** (page 122).
- The MC may invoke the crew relationship tags as weakness tags as part of any PC's action. The players mark an upgrade box on the crew theme for each such invocation.
- The crew relationship tags can be restored or changed during **Credit Roll** (page 125).